

History
HISTORY 1DD3
The Making of the Modern World,
1750-1945
Winter 2027



HUMANITIES

Instructor Information

Stephen Heathorn
Email: heaths@mcmaster.ca
Office: CNH 631
Office Hours:
TBD

Course Information

Lectures: Tu & Fr 2:30-3:20

Labs:

Tutorials: Yes. Arranged by Registrar.

Course Dates: 01/04/2027 - 04/07/2027

Units: 3.00

Course Delivery Mode: In Person

Course Description: An introduction to themes of global oppression and resistance, trade and consumption, the movement of peoples and ideas, and environmental change across the 19th and 20th centuries. Three hours (lectures and tutorials); one term May be offered in person or online

Instructor-Specific Course Information

This course examines thematically the history of the interaction of the West with the rest of the World from the mid 18th Century until the period right after the Second World War. It is designed as both a basic survey of the major issues of this period and as an introduction to the study of history at the university level. An understanding of the contemporary world requires knowledge about how this

world came to be what it is. The past, present and future are not separate domains: the present is a product of the past, and what happened in the past helps to shape the future. History is the pursuit of interpretations of the past based on the research and analysis of surviving evidence. Historians follow rules of evidence and seek to understand the issues they discuss by rigorously researching the context of the past. However, historians also make sense of the past through the prism of their own culture and the issues of the present: this is why each generation asks new questions about the past, and why historical interpretations are never static or monolithic. Judgments about the past are constantly being revised and re-interpreted based on new questions and on the researching of new evidence. Historians sometimes disagree over these interpretations; sometimes they disagree over the evidence used to support these interpretations. This course aims to make some sense of these disagreements while at the same time building student knowledge of the development of our modern world.

Important Links

- [Mosaic](#)
- [Avenue to Learn](#)
- [Student Accessibility Services - Accommodations](#)
- [McMaster University Library](#)
- [eReserves](#)
- [Open Education Resources](#)

Course Learning Outcomes

- To think about historical interpretation and the nature of historical evidence
- To develop analytical and critical reading abilities, time-management and note-taking skills, and to improve oral and written communication skills
- To encourage intellectual curiosity about, and provide a solid grounding of knowledge in, key events and concepts that shaped the globe over the course of the period c. 1750 to the just after the Second World War, c. 1945.

Required Materials and Texts

Please sign in with your MacID [here](#) to view your booklist

No required book purchases. Readings will be provided free of charge via Avenue2Learn.

Class Format

In Person

The lectures are an essential part of this class and as there is no textbook attendance and the development of note taking is required to do well. All lectures will have an outline available on Avenue prior to class, but this does not substitute for lecture notes. I will also record the lectures and make them available immediately to those with excused absences from class (eg. MSAF etc.) or for those with SAS accommodations. I will make all the lecture recordings available to the entire course at the end of the term in the period immediately prior to the final exam. The recordings are not a perfect substitute for attendance in class, and I make no guarantees about the quality of the recorded lectures.

Tutorials will meet weekly and will primarily be discussions of assigned reading provided on Avenue2Learn. There are 10 tutorials spaced over the course but only 8 will be counted in the tutorial mark, so you can miss 2 for whatever reason and still earn full marks for tutorials. Tutorial participation marks are broken down into attendance (1.5% for attending per tutorial), and actual participation grade (upto 2% per tutorial) based on the amount and quality of participation. Students will have the opportunity to self-assess their performance in tutorial at the end of each class, which will be considered in the marking of participation, but the final decision on the mark rests with the TA.

Course Evaluation

Participation in tutorials: 28%

Document Analyses (1000 words): 2 @ 15% each = 30%

In-Class Mid-Term Test: 12%

Final Exam: 30%

Undergraduate Grading Scale

The grades breakdown for McMaster's 12-Point Grading Scale

Grade	Equivalent Grade Point	Equivalent Percentages
A+	12	90-100
A	11	85-89
A-	10	80-84
B+	9	77-79
B	8	73-76
B-	7	70-72
C+	6	67-69
C	5	63-66
C-	4	60-62
D+	3	57-59
D	2	53-56
D-	1	50-52
F	0	0-49

Course Schedule

Lecture Schedule

Tutorial topics and readings will be provided on Avenue2Learn

Week of 4 Jan. Introduction & European Enlightenment

Week of 11 Jan. The American & French Revolutions

Tutorials begin

Week of 18 Jan. The French Revolution & Napoleonic Wars

2nd tutorial

Week of 25 Jan. Industrialization

3rd tutorial

Week of 1 Feb. European Colonialism and Latin America

4th tutorial

Week of 8 Feb. Lecture catch-up/review & In-class **Mid Term Test, 25 Feb.**

No tutorials this week

Week of 15 Feb. *Reading Week*

Week of 22 Feb. Challenge of Modernity to Traditional Empires 1: China & Japan

5th tutorial

1st paper due, midnight, 26 Feb.

Week of 1 Mar. Challenge of Modernity to Traditional Empires 2: Russian and Ottoman Empires

6th tutorial

Week of 8 Mar. First World War

7th tutorial

Week of 15 Mar. Socialism, Marxism, Bolshevik Revolution

8th tutorial

Week of 22 Mar. Fascism and Nazism

9th tutorial

2nd paper due, midnight, 26 Mar.

Week of 29 Mar. Second World War

10th tutorial

Week of 4 April. Establishing the Post-War New Order

No tutorials

Final Exam TBD: scheduled by Registrar's Office.

Late Assignments

Late assignments will be penalized at the rate of 3% per day.

Turnitin.com

This course uses a web-based service (Turnitin.com) to reveal authenticity and ownership of student submitted work. For courses using such software, students will be expected to submit their work electronically either directly to Turnitin.com or via an online learning platform (e.g. A2L, etc.) using plagiarism detection (a service supported by Turnitin.com) so it can be checked for academic dishonesty.

Students who do not wish their work to be submitted through the plagiarism detection software must inform the Instructor before the assignment is due. No penalty will be assigned to a student who does not submit work to the plagiarism detection software. All submitted work is subject to normal verification that standards of academic integrity have been upheld (e.g., on-line search, other software, etc.). For more details about McMaster's use of Turnitin.com please go to www.mcmaster.ca/academicintegrity.

Generative AI: Use Prohibited

Students are not permitted to use generative AI in this course. In alignment with [McMaster academic integrity policy](#), it "shall be an offence knowingly to ... submit academic work for assessment that was purchased or acquired from another source". This includes work created by generative AI tools. Also stated in the policy is the following, "Contract Cheating is the act of "outsourcing of student work to third parties" (Lancaster & Clarke, 2016, p. 639) with or without payment." Using Generative AI tools is a form of contract cheating. Charges of academic dishonesty will be brought forward to the Office of Academic Integrity.

APPROVED ADVISORY STATEMENTS

Academic Integrity

You are expected to exhibit honesty and use ethical behaviour in all aspects of the learning process. Academic credentials you earn are rooted in principles of

honesty and academic integrity. **It is your responsibility to understand what constitutes academic dishonesty.**

Academic dishonesty is to knowingly act or fail to act in a way that results or could result in unearned academic credit or advantage. This behaviour can result in serious consequences, e.g. the grade of zero on an assignment, loss of credit with a notation on the transcript (notation reads: "Grade of F assigned for academic dishonesty"), and/or suspension or expulsion from the university. For information on the various types of academic dishonesty please refer to the [Academic Integrity Policy](#).

The following illustrates only three forms of academic dishonesty:

- plagiarism, e.g. the submission of work that is not one's own or for which other credit has been obtained.
- improper collaboration in group work.
- copying or using unauthorized aids in tests and examinations.

Authenticity / Plagiarism

Some courses may use a web-based service (Turnitin.com) to reveal authenticity and ownership of student submitted work. For courses using such software, students will be expected to submit their work electronically either directly to Turnitin.com or via an online learning platform (e.g. Avenue to Learn, etc.) using plagiarism detection (a service supported by Turnitin.com) so it can be checked for academic dishonesty.

Students who do not wish their work to be submitted through the plagiarism detection software must inform the Instructor before the assignment is due. No penalty will be assigned to a student who does not submit work to the plagiarism detection software. **All submitted work is subject to normal verification that standards of academic integrity have been upheld** (e.g., on-line search, other software, etc.). For more details about McMaster's use of Turnitin.com please go to www.mcmaster.ca/academicintegrity.

Courses with an On-line Element

Some courses may use on-line elements (e.g. e-mail, Avenue to Learn, LearnLink, web pages, capa, Moodle, ThinkingCap, etc.). Students should be aware that, when they access the electronic components of a course using these elements, private information such as first and last names, user names for the McMaster e-mail accounts, and program affiliation may become apparent to all other students in the same course. The available information is dependent on the technology used. Continuation in a course that uses on-line elements will be deemed consent to this disclosure. If you have any questions or concerns about such disclosure please discuss this with the course instructor.

Online Proctoring

Some courses may use online proctoring software for tests and exams. This software may require students to turn on their video camera, present identification, monitor and record their computer activities, and/or lock/restrict their browser or other applications/software during tests or exams. This software may be required to be installed before the test/exam begins.

Conduct Expectations

As a McMaster student, you have the right to experience, and the responsibility to demonstrate, respectful and dignified interactions within all of our living, learning and working communities. These expectations are described in the [Code of Student Rights & Responsibilities](#) (the "Code"). All students share the responsibility of maintaining a positive environment for the academic and personal growth of all McMaster community members, **whether in person or online.**

It is essential that students be mindful of their interactions online, as the Code remains in effect in virtual learning environments. The Code applies to any interactions that adversely affect, disrupt, or interfere with reasonable participation in University activities. Student disruptions or behaviours that interfere with university functions on online platforms (e.g. use of Avenue 2 Learn, WebEx or

Zoom for delivery), will be taken very seriously and will be investigated. Outcomes may include restriction or removal of the involved students' access to these platforms.

Academic Accommodation of Students with Disabilities

Students with disabilities who require academic accommodation must contact [Student Accessibility Services](#) (SAS) at 905-525-9140 ext. 28652 or sas@mcmaster.ca to make arrangements with a Program Coordinator. For further information, consult McMaster University's [Academic Accommodation of Students with Disabilities](#) policy.

Requests for Relief for Missed Academic Term Work

In the event of an absence for medical or other reasons, students should review and follow the [Policy on Requests for Relief for Missed Academic Term Work](#).

Academic Accommodation for Religious, Indigenous, or Spiritual Observances (RISO)

Students requiring academic accommodation based on religious, Indigenous or spiritual observances should follow the procedures set out in the [RISO](#) policy. Students should submit their request to their Faculty Office ***normally within 10 working days*** of the beginning of term in which they anticipate a need for accommodation or to the Registrar's Office prior to their examinations. Students should also contact their instructors as soon as possible to make alternative arrangements for classes, assignments, and tests.

Copyright and Recording

Students are advised that lectures, demonstrations, performances, and any other course material provided by an instructor include copyright protected works. The Copyright Act and copyright law protect every original literary, dramatic, musical and artistic work, **including lectures** by University instructors.

The recording of lectures, tutorials, or other methods of instruction may occur during a course. Recording may be done by either the instructor for the purpose of authorized distribution, or by a student for the purpose of personal study. Students should be aware that their voice and/or image may be recorded by others during the class. Please speak with the instructor if this is a concern for you.

Extreme Circumstances

The University reserves the right to change the dates and deadlines for any or all courses in extreme circumstances (e.g., severe weather, labour disruptions, etc.). Changes will be communicated through regular McMaster communication channels, such as McMaster Daily News, Avenue to Learn and/or McMaster email.